

Mark Smalley

Digital Assets · Regulatory Strategy · Blockchain Infrastructure

Seeking senior roles at RegTech, FinTech, or legal/advisory firms · UK/Europe & remote

mark@smalley.my · +44 (0) 7526 860 262 · smalley.my · Nationality: British · linkedin.com/in/msmalley

Executive Summary

One of Southeast Asia's most experienced digital asset practitioners, with a 15-year career spanning protocol engineering, regulatory engagement, and institutional client delivery. Played a direct role in shaping Malaysia's digital asset regulatory framework as the first operator admitted to the Securities Commission sandbox. Led or advised on the establishment of Malaysia's first regulated digital asset custodian, and delivered blockchain infrastructure to clients including DBS Bank and Baker Hostetler. Recognised by Deloitte as a Top 50 Global RegTech company and by industry media as a Digerati50 leader. Currently applying AI-augmented engineering and algorithmic decision systems to new product domains. Now based in the UK and seeking to bring this rare combination of deep technical credibility, regulatory market experience, and emerging AI fluency to a senior role in a RegTech, FinTech, or legal advisory firm.

Regulatory & Advisory Credentials

- First company admitted to the Securities Commission Malaysia (SC) regulatory sandbox for digital assets
- Active contributor to Malaysia's national Digital Asset regulatory roadmap — engaged directly with SC and Bank Negara Malaysia stakeholders
- Advised on Project Castor — the Securities Commission's blockchain blueprint that established Digital Asset Custodian requirements in Malaysian capital markets
- Co-founded and funded CoKeeps — Malaysia's first regulated digital asset custodian — providing two years of product development capital and three years of operational funding through R1
- Delivered blockchain and distributed ledger training and advisory to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA)
- Presented on regulatory dimensions of blockchain at the Islamic Finance News Forum (KL, 2017) and the Financial Crime Summit (2017)
- Presented at MDEC FinTech Conference and Finnovasia — addressing institutional audiences on regulatory compliance and digital asset adoption
- Registered HRDF Trainer — designed and delivered multi-day blockchain compliance workshops for financial institutions
- Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech Companies — Neuroware was the only Malaysian company listed (2017)

Work Experience

CEO & Founder R1 — Malaysia

2012 – 2025

Founded and led Malaysia's foremost blockchain infrastructure and regulatory advisory practice for 13 years. R1 sat at the intersection of engineering, compliance, and policy — building production-grade digital asset systems for licensed operators while advising regulators on the frameworks that would govern them.

- Established R1 as the first blockchain company to enter the SC Malaysia regulatory sandbox, engaging directly in the policy design process
- Designed and shipped compliant KYC and AML pipeline infrastructure adopted by licensed digital asset operators
- Co-founded, funded, and architected CoKeeps — Malaysia's first regulated digital asset custodian — investing two years of R1 capital into product development plus three operational years pending regulatory approval
- Delivered enterprise advisory engagements to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA) on blockchain compliance strategy
- Authored DN-Key, a decentralised key management protocol designed specifically for regulated custody environments
- Founded the Blockchain Embassy of Asia — Malaysia's first registered blockchain consortium with members from Maybank, RHB, Capital Bay, and ATA Plus
- Advised on Project Castor (2018) — the SC Malaysia blockchain blueprint that introduced Digital Asset Custodian regulation into capital markets. Technical implementation progressed from Dogecoin (distributed key-value storage) to Ethereum (ERC-20/721 token standards with programmable compliance)
- Built and maintained long-term relationships with Securities Commission Malaysia, central bank stakeholders, and regional FinTech bodies

Chief Blockchain Officer Oviato — United Kingdom

Feb 2025 – Mar 2026

Co-founded and led the technical pivot from consumer application to passkey-native identity and custody infrastructure — demonstrating how WebAuthN can meet institutional-grade security requirements. Secured DraperVC investment.

- Designed cryptographic framework and passkey/WebAuthN architecture for next-generation non-custodial wallet infrastructure
- Contributed to investor materials and technical due diligence process that resulted in DraperVC funding
- Demonstrated how passkey-native infrastructure can meet institutional-grade security requirements without traditional custodial risk

- Head of Engineering

CakeDefi — Singapore

Feb 2023 - Sep 2023

Engaged to design new Bitcoin meta-protocols and lead an innovation team. Co-authored the open SADO Protocol standard — an open-source, auditable trading infrastructure for Bitcoin assets.

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Co-authored SADO Protocol — open-source, self-authenticating decentralised order-book standard for Bitcoin Ordinals, with implications for compliant on-chain asset trading

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Demonstrated how open protocol design can underpin transparent, auditable trading infrastructure on Bitcoin
- Chief Technology Officer

Neuroware Inc — USA / Malaysia

2013 - 2018

500 Startups-funded (Batch 9, US\$300K+ raised) company providing blockchain compliance infrastructure to licensed FinTech operators and regulators across Southeast Asia. Launched at TechCrunch Disrupt London. The only Malaysian company in Deloitte's Top 50 Global RegTech.

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Built blockchain infrastructure adopted by licensed financial institutions operating under regulatory oversight

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Helped Maybank implement MongoDB for their PFM module — the first bank in Asia to adopt MongoDB for personal financial management

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Engaged directly with regulators to demonstrate technical compliance with emerging distributed ledger frameworks

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Delivered hackathon infrastructure to DBS Bank; systems handled over 1 million API requests across the event
- CEO & Founder (active)

Moddable Limited — United Kingdom

2025 - present

Open-source games studio leveraging AI-augmented engineering to deliver a portfolio of products at solo-founder velocity. Demonstrates continued technical leadership and ability to ship production software using emerging AI tooling.

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Shipped four live products and two open-source engines in under six months using LLM-driven development workflows

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Designed procedural generation and AI decision systems — relevant domain knowledge for algorithmic compliance and risk-scoring tooling

Domain Expertise

Regulatory	Digital asset regulation, sandbox engagement, SC Malaysia, KYC/AML framework design, custody compliance
Technical	Blockchain protocol design, cryptographic infrastructure, passkeys/WebAuthN, smart contracts, AI-augmented workflows, algorithmic decision systems
Advisory	Institutional client delivery, FinTech strategy, whitepaper authorship, due diligence support, board-level briefing
Sectors	Digital asset custody, RegTech, Islamic Finance / FinTech, payments, identity, DeFi infrastructure
Geographies	United Kingdom, Malaysia, Singapore, Southeast Asia — regulatory environments across all jurisdictions

Speaking & Publications

- TEDx Sarawak (2017) — 'The Cost of Cash': blockchain, digital currency, and financial inclusion
- Islamic Finance News Forum, Kuala Lumpur (2017) — gold, Bitcoin, and digital Sunnah instruments for Islamic Finance
- Financial Crime Summit (2017) — blockchain applications in financial crime prevention and compliance
- MDEC FinTech Conference — 'Banking on the Future of Blockchains': addressing institutional adoption
- Finnovasia — regional FinTech leadership forum, presenting on blockchain infrastructure for financial services
- Published: 'Unravelling Blockchain's Future' — IFN (Islamic Finance News), 2017

Credentials & Recognition

Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech Companies	Digerati50 — Malaysia's Top 50 Digital Leaders
500 Startups Batch 9 — Top 5 by VentureBeat	Antler Malaysia Batch 2
Registered HRDF Trainer	Silver Duke of Edinburgh Award

References

Shafiu Hussain	U-Zyn Chua
CEO, Oviato · shaf@oviato.com	Founder & CTO, Cake Group (Singapore) · chua@uzyn.com